AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Investec × ASCO

Youth Futures and Green Communities Pilot

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: A selected South African community where ASCO has verified local access and need; final province/municipality should be agreed with Investec after due diligence (do not imply an existing Investec footprint or partner site).

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Investec** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Youth Futures and Green Communities Pilot**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Youth Futures and Green Communities Pilot in A selected South African community where ASCO has verified local access and need; final province/municipality should be agreed with Investec after due diligence (do not imply an existing Investec footprint or partner site)., benefiting Proposed: approximately 100 disadvantaged secondary-school learners and young adults, with inclusion of educators/caregivers and community volunteers; final numbers and eligibility to be confirmed through a baseline assessment. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Investec's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
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Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Youth Futures and Green Communities Pilot

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
A selected South African community where ASCO has verified local access and need; final province/municipality should be agreed with Investec after due diligence (do not imply an existing Investec footprint or partner site).

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: approximately 100 disadvantaged secondary-school learners and young adults, with inclusion of educators/caregivers and community volunteers; final numbers and eligibility to be confirmed through a baseline assessment.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: deliver 12 structured education and future-work-readiness workshops for Grade 8–12 learners, with attendance and pre/post learning measures.
- Proposed: provide 4 youth/community development sessions covering career planning, digital/financial literacy and introductory entrepreneurship, with referrals where appropriate.
- Proposed: run 4 practical environmental-responsibility activities (for example conservation education, waste reduction or greening) linked to learner-led community action; select the activity only after a local environmental assessment.
- Proposed: train at least 10 community/youth facilitators or volunteers and produce a safeguarding, monitoring and learning report.
- Proposed: submit a close-out report covering beneficiaries reached, participation, learning results, environmental activities, expenditure against the R100,000 ask and lessons for scale-up.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Investec?

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Verified company context

- Investec South Africa states that its CSI approach focuses on education and entrepreneurship to support employment, wealth creation and socio-economic growth in South Africa.
- Investec's stated overall CSI aim is to create opportunities for young people to become active participants in society, through a continuum from high school to tertiary education and young-adult learning/workplace preparation.
- Investec's Southern Africa community strategy identifies education and learnerships, entrepreneurship and job creation, and the environment as focus areas.
- The Southern Africa objectives include improving learners' progression in mathematics, English and science; expanding access to tertiary education; enabling youth on-the-job training; supporting young entrepreneurs; and conservation education/clean, resource-rich environments.
- Invest-ED is described as a national programme for Grade 8–12 learners, parents and guardians, focused on future-work readiness, career pathways and economic participation; its page provides an event registration link.
- The high-school bursary page specifies South African citizenship, financial need and academic potential as criteria, with emphasis on pure Mathematics, Accounting and Science; it directs applicants to StudyTrust. These are bursary criteria, not stated criteria for NGO grants.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Use Investec South Africa's official contact form and select the general-query option: https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/contact-us.html. The page lists Sandton general queries at +27 (11) 286 7000. In the message, request routing to the South Africa CSI/community-investment team and ask whether unsolicited NGO proposals are accepted and what due-diligence documents are required. A dedicated CSI application route was not found on the reviewed official pages.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- Section 18A approved | Effective 9 October 2026
- Do not claim completed ASCO results, existing Investec/other partnerships, or any Investec funding commitment.
- Investec's published CSI pages emphasise education and entrepreneurship; environmental work is described in the broader Southern Africa strategy, but no specific public grant criteria for a combined education/environment project were found.
- The high-school bursary eligibility rules should not be assumed to apply to organisational CSI proposals.
- Funding amount, geographic scope, due diligence, safeguarding, monitoring requirements, procurement rules and whether unsolicited proposals are accepted were not stated on the reviewed pages and require confirmation.
- The official contact page offers a general-query form and Sandton general-queries phone number, but does not identify a dedicated CSI applications inbox or portal.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Investec** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/sustainability/our-community.html
2. https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/sustainability/sustainability-report/commitment-to-our-communities/southern-africa.html
3. https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/sustainability/sustainability-report.html
4. https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/sustainability/our-community/invest-ed.html
5. https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/sustainability/our-community/bursaries/high-school-bursary-programme.html
6. https://www.investec.com/en_za/welcome-to-investec/contact-us.html
7. https://www.investec.com/en_gb/welcome-to-investec/sustainability.html
8. https://www.investec.com/en_gb/welcome-to-investec/sustainability/our-environment.html

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.